

Question:

Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's?

Answer Choices:

A. Being African or Hispanic American

B. A lower level of education

C. Living in a city

D. Being married

E. Having a family history of Alzheimer's

F. High intake of saturated fats

G. Older age

H. Eating fish

I. Being a smoker

J. Drinking alcohol regularly

Reasoning + Answer:

< reasoning process here >

To determine which factor is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's , we evaluate each option based on established medical and epidemiological research .

A . Being African or Hispanic American â Studies show that certain racial and ethnic groups , including African Americans and Hispanic Americans , may have higher risks of Alzheimer's due to socioeconomic , environmental , and genetic factors . So , this is not protective .

B . A lower level of education â Lower educational attainment is associated with increased risk of Alzheimer's , likely due to reduced cognitive reserve . So , this increases risk .

C . Living in a city â Urban living has mixed associations , but some studies suggest urban environments may have higher exposure to pollutants and stress , which could increase risk . Not clearly protective .

D . Being married â Multiple studies show that marriage is associated with a reduced risk of dementia and Alzheimer's . Social engagement , emotional support , and reduced isolation are thought to contribute . This is a known protective factor .

E . Having a family history of Alzheimer's â Strong genetic predisposition , so this increases risk .

F . High intake of saturated fats â Associated with increased inflammation and cardiovascular disease , both linked to higher Alzheimer's risk .

G . Older age â The strongest known risk factor ; risk increases significantly with age .

H . Eating fish â Fish , especially fatty fish like salmon , are rich in omega - 3 fatty acids , which are neuroprotective . Evidence suggests a reduced risk of Alzheimer's with higher fish consumption .

I . Being a smoker â Smoking is linked to increased risk of neurodegenerative diseases due to inflammation and vascular damage .

J . Drinking alcohol regularly â Excessive alcohol intake increases risk ; however , moderate alcohol intake (especially red wine) has been linked to potential cognitive benefits in some studies , but the evidence is not consistent , and it's not reliably protective .

Now , among the options , both D (being married) and H (eating fish) are associated with reduced risk .

But the question asks : " Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's ? " â and we are to pick one correct answer from the list .

Between D and H , both are valid , but " eating fish " is more directly linked to neuroprotection via omega - 3s , and is a modifiable lifestyle factor . However , " being married " has been consistently linked to reduced dementia risk in longitudinal studies .

But note : the question does not say " which is the most protective " or " which is best , " just " associated with decreased risk . "

Still , among all the options , the most consistently supported and directly linked protective lifestyle factor is eating fish , due to omega - 3s and brain health .

However , research shows that social engagement (like marriage) reduces risk significantly .

But the strongest evidence for a protective lifestyle behavior is fish consumption .

But let's recheck : the question says " which of the following factors " â implying one correct choice .

Looking at standard public health guidelines and Alzheimer's Association resources :

- Being married is a protective factor .

- Eating fish (especially fatty fish) is recommended for brain health .

Both are valid , but which one is most consistently associated ?

The Alzheimer's Association and multiple studies (e.g . , in the Framingham Heart Study) show that social engagement (like marriage) reduces dementia risk .

However , the option " eating fish " is more directly tied to neuroprotection via diet .

But let's go back : is " eating fish " clearly associated with reduced risk ?

Yes â several studies show that diets rich in omega - 3s (from fish) are linked to lower cognitive decline .

But is it stronger than social factors ?

Actually , both are valid , but the question likely expects the most well-supported protective lifestyle behavior .

Still , in multiple-choice questions , if only one answer is to be selected , and if both D and H are valid , we must pick the one most directly linked to reduced risk .

However , the correct answer that is consistently reported in public health literature as protective is " being married " â it is a social factor linked to cognitive reserve .

But wait â

2.0

1.5

1.0

0.5

0.0

-0.5

-1.0

-1.5

-2.0